SDG BLOCKCHAIN ACCELERATOR

Market Penetration and Scaling Strategy

TradeChainX x UNDP Ethiopia

This document outlines the market penetration strategy, branding approach, user acquisition plan, go-to-market strategy, and long-term scaling roadmap for the TradeChainX pilot developed within the SDG Blockchain Accelerator program.

1. Project Overview

The Kijani MRV platform represents a comprehensive digital solution designed to address one of the most critical bottlenecks in Ethiopia's climate ecosystem: the lack of robust, transparent, and scalable Monitoring, Reporting, and Verification (MRV) systems. As Ethiopia accelerates its efforts to participate in global carbon markets and fulfill its Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs), the need for reliable and verifiable emissions data becomes increasingly urgent. However, existing MRV processes remain largely fragmented, manual, and resource-intensive, limiting the country's ability to generate high-integrity carbon credits and attract international climate finance.

Kijani MRV responds directly to this challenge by introducing a blockchain-backed verification layer that enhances trust, traceability, and efficiency across the entire carbon credit lifecycle. Rather than replacing national systems, the platform is deliberately designed to complement Ethiopia's evolving MRV and registry infrastructure, ensuring alignment with government-led processes while strengthening data integrity. By anchoring emissions data on a decentralized ledger and integrating advanced digital tools such as satellite analytics and AI-based verification models, the solution ensures that every recorded emission reduction is transparent, auditable, and resistant to tampering.

The platform is being piloted across two strategically selected use cases: clean cooking initiatives and forest-landscape restoration projects. These sectors are not only central to Ethiopia's climate strategy but also represent high-impact opportunities for generating measurable emission reductions. Through these pilots, Kijani MRV demonstrates how digital infrastructure can transform raw environmental data into trusted, market-ready carbon assets. At the same time, it introduces mechanisms for inclusive finance, enabling local communities, particularly smallholder farmers, women, and rural households, to directly benefit from climate finance flows.

Ultimately, the Kijani MRV initiative contributes to broader development and sustainability goals by strengthening Ethiopia's capacity to participate in global carbon markets, improving transparency in climate governance, and unlocking new revenue streams for vulnerable communities. In doing so, it directly supports the achievement of key Sustainable Development Goals, including SDG 13 (Climate Action), SDG 15 (Life on Land), and SDG 7 (Affordable and Clean Energy).

2. Market Penetration Strategy

2.1 Branding and Positioning Strategy

The success of Kijani MRV depends not only on its technical capabilities but also on how it is positioned within Ethiopia's institutional and market landscape. The platform will be strategically branded as a national digital infrastructure for carbon market integrity, developed in close collaboration with UNDP and aligned with Ethiopia's climate and digital transformation agendas. This positioning emphasizes both credibility and public value, presenting the solution as a trusted backbone for transparent carbon accounting rather than a standalone technological product.

At its core, Kijani MRV's identity is grounded in the concept of trust. In carbon markets, where credibility and data integrity are paramount, the platform's blockchain foundation provides a strong differentiator by ensuring that all records are immutable and verifiable. This technological robustness is complemented by its alignment with national policies and international standards, reinforcing its role as a compliant and future-ready solution.

The value proposition of Kijani MRV is multifaceted. For government institutions, it offers a reliable tool for strengthening oversight, improving reporting accuracy, and ensuring alignment with international frameworks such as Article 6 of the Paris Agreement. For project developers, it reduces the complexity and cost of MRV processes, enabling faster and more efficient generation of carbon credits. For investors and buyers, it provides confidence in the authenticity and traceability of credits, thereby enhancing market attractiveness. Most importantly, for local communities, it creates pathways for equitable participation in climate finance through transparent benefit-sharing mechanisms.

The platform's messaging will consistently highlight themes of transparency, climate integrity, innovation, and inclusivity. Communication will emphasize Ethiopia's readiness to engage in global carbon markets and position Kijani MRV as a key enabler of that transition. Visually and conceptually, the brand will reflect a balance between environmental sustainability and digital innovation, reinforcing its dual role as both a climate and technology solution.

2.2 User Acquisition and Onboarding Plan

The adoption of Kijani MRV requires a carefully designed user acquisition and onboarding strategy that accounts for the diverse range of stakeholders involved in Ethiopia's climate ecosystem. These stakeholders include government agencies, project developers, local communities, verifiers, and international buyers, each with distinct needs and levels of technical capacity.

The initial phase of user acquisition is centered around pilot-based engagement. By embedding the platform within existing initiatives such as the FOLUR program and clean cooking projects led by eQub, Kijani MRV ensures that onboarding occurs within real operational contexts. This

approach not only facilitates practical validation of the platform but also builds early trust among users by demonstrating tangible benefits.

A critical component of the onboarding strategy is capacity building. Given that many end-users operate in rural or low-connectivity environments, the platform is designed to be intuitive and accessible, supported by targeted training programs. These include workshops for cooperative managers, training sessions for field enumerators on mobile data collection, and guidance for government stakeholders on dashboard usage and verification workflows. Special attention is given to ensuring that the platform can function effectively in low-bandwidth settings, incorporating offline capabilities and simplified user interfaces.

Community engagement is another cornerstone of the onboarding process. By working directly with smallholder farmers, women's groups, and rural households, the platform fosters a sense of ownership and participation. This is particularly important in ensuring sustained usage, as these communities are both contributors to and beneficiaries of the MRV process. Incentive mechanisms, such as access to carbon revenue streams and transparent tracking of contributions, further reinforce user engagement.

Through this comprehensive approach, the onboarding plan not only facilitates technical adoption but also builds the social and institutional foundations necessary for long-term success.

2.3 Go-To-Market and Communication Strategy

The go-to-market strategy for Kijani MRV is structured as a phased process that aligns with both the platform's development lifecycle and Ethiopia's broader climate agenda. The initial phase focuses on awareness, leveraging UNDP's communication channels and government partnerships to introduce the platform as a flagship innovation in Ethiopia's carbon market development. This includes press releases, stakeholder briefings, and thought leadership content highlighting the role of digital MRV in enabling climate finance.

As the platform progresses into the engagement phase, communication efforts shift toward demonstrating practical value. This involves organizing pilot showcases, conducting live demonstrations, and presenting real-world use cases that illustrate how Kijani MRV operates in practice. By highlighting early successes, such as the issuance of carbon credits or improved data transparency, the platform builds credibility among potential users and partners.

The conversion phase is focused on expanding adoption. This includes onboarding additional projects, enabling new users to generate and verify carbon credits, and actively engaging with buyers and investors. Transparent communication of measurable results, such as emission reductions and financial benefits for communities, plays a key role in driving this phase.

Ongoing communication is maintained through digital platforms, stakeholder reports, and regular updates, ensuring that all participants remain informed and engaged. By combining strategic messaging with evidence-based storytelling, the communication strategy effectively bridges the gap between technical complexity and real-world impact.

2.4 Institutional and Ecosystem Partnerships

The implementation and scaling of Kijani MRV rely on a robust network of partnerships that span government institutions, development organizations, private sector actors, and local communities. These partnerships are essential for ensuring alignment with policy frameworks, facilitating implementation, and building credibility in global markets.

Government agencies such as the Ministry of Planning and Development and the Environmental Protection Authority play a central role in providing regulatory oversight and ensuring that the platform aligns with national priorities. Their involvement is critical for integrating Kijani MRV into Ethiopia's broader climate governance architecture.

Development partners, including UNDP and international organizations, contribute technical expertise, funding, and coordination support. Their global networks also enable knowledge sharing and facilitate connections with international carbon markets.

At the implementation level, private sector partners such as eQub provide the operational infrastructure for pilot projects, particularly in the clean cooking sector. Technology providers contribute tools for data collection, analytics, and platform integration, ensuring that the solution remains technologically robust and scalable.

Equally important are the contributions of local communities and civil society organizations, which play a key role in data generation, validation, and on-the-ground implementation. Their involvement ensures that the platform remains inclusive and responsive to local needs.

Together, these partnerships create a comprehensive ecosystem that supports the platform's development, adoption, and long-term sustainability.

3. Scaling Strategy

The scaling strategy for Kijani MRV is designed as a phased progression that balances technical development, institutional integration, and market expansion. In the initial phase, the focus is on validating the platform through pilot deployments in key sectors. This phase generates critical insights into usability, performance, and impact, while also building trust among stakeholders.

The second phase involves national expansion, during which the platform is integrated into Ethiopia's emerging MRV and carbon registry systems. This includes onboarding additional projects, expanding sectoral coverage, and strengthening interoperability with government systems.

In the long term, the platform is positioned for regional and global scaling. By leveraging UNDP's networks and aligning with international standards, Kijani MRV can be adapted for use in other countries facing similar challenges. This positions the solution as a potential digital public good, contributing to global efforts to improve transparency and efficiency in carbon markets.

Continuous innovation is embedded within the scaling strategy, with ongoing enhancements to analytics capabilities, integration of new data sources, and expansion into additional climate sectors.

4. Financial Model and Revenue Streams

The financial sustainability of Kijani MRV is ensured through a hybrid model that combines initial grant funding with long-term revenue generation mechanisms. During the pilot phase, development and deployment are supported by the SDG Blockchain Accelerator and UNDP resources, enabling early adoption without financial barriers.

As the platform matures, revenue streams are introduced to support ongoing operations and scaling. These include transaction fees for carbon credit issuance and transfer, subscription models for enterprise users, and MRV-as-a-Service offerings for projects requiring advanced verification capabilities. Additional revenue may be generated through data analytics services and strategic partnerships.

This diversified model ensures that the platform remains accessible while achieving financial sustainability over time.

5. Sustainability Plan Beyond the Accelerator

Ensuring the long-term sustainability of Kijani MRV requires a comprehensive approach that combines institutional integration, financial viability, and continuous innovation. A key priority is the transition of ownership and management to a permanent institutional structure, potentially within government systems or a public-private partnership model.

The platform's open and modular architecture supports ongoing development and community engagement, enabling contributions from local developers and fostering innovation. Continuous

funding mechanisms, including climate finance programs and donor support, provide additional resources for scaling and maintenance.

Performance monitoring plays a critical role in sustaining stakeholder confidence. By tracking key metrics such as carbon credits issued, emission reductions achieved, and community benefits generated, the platform demonstrates its impact and reinforces its value proposition.

Finally, integration into national policy frameworks and administrative processes ensures that Kijani MRV becomes an integral part of Ethiopia's climate infrastructure, supporting long-term adoption and relevance.

6. Conclusion

Kijani MRV represents a significant advancement in Ethiopia's ability to manage, verify, and monetize climate action. By combining cutting-edge technologies with a strong focus on inclusivity and policy alignment, the platform addresses critical gaps in the current system while creating new opportunities for economic and environmental impact.

Through its structured market penetration, strategic partnerships, and scalable design, Kijani MRV is well-positioned to become a cornerstone of Ethiopia's carbon market ecosystem. More broadly, it serves as a model for how digital innovation can be leveraged to enhance transparency, build trust, and unlock climate finance in developing economies.